

5-Day Solo Trip to Milan (June 2026)

Milan blends world-class culture with a relaxed lifestyle. The following five-day plan balances must-see monuments and museums, local food experiences and time to unwind. June weather is warm and pleasant, so start early, stay hydrated and keep afternoons flexible. Opening times may change – confirm closer to your visit.

Day 1 – Heart of Milan: Duomo, Galleria & Brera

Morning

1. **Duomo di Milano** – Begin at the city's iconic cathedral. The Gothic masterpiece took over six centuries to build and uses pinkish-white marble from the Candoglia quarries ¹. Inside, statues decorate the columns, stained-glass windows depict biblical scenes such as the Last Judgement and a brass sundial on the floor was used to measure time ². Take the elevator to the terraces for close views of the spires and the golden Madonnina statue plus panoramas over Milan ³. The Duomo is open daily 9:00–19:00 ⁴; book a combined ticket (cathedral, rooftop and museum) in advance.
2. **Galleria Vittorio Emanuele II** – From Piazza Duomo walk through this 19th-century arcade connecting the cathedral to La Scala. The neo-Renaissance gallery is one of Europe's greatest iron-and-glass structures ⁵. Its cross-shaped plan culminates in an octagonal atrium with a 47-m-high glass dome ⁶. Browse historic cafés and luxury boutiques and spin three times on the mosaic bull for luck ⁷. A rooftop walkway ("Highline Galleria") offers aperitivo with views over Piazza Duomo ⁸.

Lunch

Try a traditional trattoria. Il Liberty in Porta Nuova serves a refined take on Milanese classics; its signature dishes include saffron risotto with marrow and licorice cream and a thick veal cutlet ⁹. La Semivuota, between Centrale and Porta Nuova, revives dishes like saffron risotto and *mondeghili* (meatballs) handed down from the chef's grandmother ¹⁰. Book ahead.

Afternoon

1. **Pinacoteca di Brera** – This renowned gallery houses works by Raphael, Mantegna, Caravaggio and other Italian masters. It is open Tuesday–Sunday 08:30–19:15 (last entrance 18:00); closed Mondays and major holidays ¹¹. Reservations are required ¹². Afterwards, wander the cobbled lanes of Brera district, stopping at cafés and independent boutiques.
2. **La Scala Museum & Theatre** – Consider a guided tour of the historic opera house. Tours last about 60 minutes and include the museum and theatre boxes; they run Monday–Saturday (subject to rehearsal schedules), cost around €35 and may be cancelled at short notice ¹³. Check the theatre's website for schedules and dress codes; attending an evening performance can be a memorable splurge.

Evening

1. **Aperitivo at Camparino or Bar Basso** – Experience Milan's aperitivo ritual. *Camparino in Galleria*, opened by Davide Campari in 1915, introduced an innovative soda-water system that served perfectly chilled Campari and soda ¹⁴. Its art-nouveau interiors and cocktails like the Campari Seltz or Negroni have made it a "temple of mixology" and one of the world's top bars ¹⁵. **Bar Basso**, a 1940s institution, famously invented the *Negroni Sbagliato* in 1972 by replacing gin with sparkling wine; the lighter cocktail became a classic ¹⁶. The bar's convivial atmosphere draws designers, artists and students ¹⁷.
2. **Dinner in Navigli** – Take the tram to the Navigli district. The Naviglio Grande canal is lined with cafés and restaurants where you can watch the world go by ¹⁸. The neighborhood boasts art galleries and the *Mercato Metropolitano* food market with street-food stalls ¹⁹. Join a Milanese evening tour or simply stroll the canal, enjoy *aperitivo* and choose a trattoria for dinner.

Day 2 – Castles & Green Spaces

Morning

1. **Castello Sforzesco** – Built in the 15th century by Francesco Sforza, this fortress now houses multiple museums. Entry tickets allow access to all museums and the courtyards. The museums are open Tuesday–Sunday 10:00–17:30 (last entry 16:30) and closed on Mondays ²⁰. Courtyards are free to enter daily 07:00–19:30 ²⁰. Highlights include Michelangelo's unfinished *Rondanini Pietà* and the Sala delle Asse fresco by Leonardo (under restoration ²¹). Spend a couple of hours exploring.
2. **Parco Sempione** – Exit through the castle into Milan's largest park. This green oasis offers wide lawns, ponds and tree-lined paths perfect for a picnic or leisurely stroll. The park's Peace Arch (Arco della Pace) frames a grand vista ²². Bring snacks or pick up lunch from nearby cafés.

Afternoon

1. **Triennale Milano** – Located in Parco Sempione, this design and architecture institution hosts exhibitions, performances and a design museum. The complex is open Tuesday–Sunday 10:30–23:30, while exhibitions and installations close at 20:00 ²³. The garden and restaurants provide a relaxing break; admission is free to public areas, but some exhibitions require a ticket ²⁴.
2. **Bosco Verticale & Porta Nuova** – Wander to the modern Porta Nuova district to see Stefano Boeri's award-winning *Bosco Verticale* ("Vertical Forest"). Two residential towers (110 m and 76 m) host **800 trees, 4 500 shrubs and 20 000 plants**, condensing the equivalent of five hectares of woodland into a footprint of just ~1 000 m² ²⁵. This sustainable design improves air quality and urban biodiversity ²⁶. Continue to Piazza Gae Aulenti and Corso Como, known for contemporary architecture and cafés.

Evening

1. **Dinner & Local Dishes** – Sample Milanese specialties like:
2. **Risotto alla Milanese** – creamy rice cooked with meat broth, butter, onion, Grana Padano cheese and saffron ²⁷.

3. **Ossobuco** – slow-cooked veal shank served with gremolada and polenta ²⁷ .
4. **Cotoletta alla Milanese** – a fried veal cutlet, crisp on the outside and tender inside ²⁷ .
5. **Cassoeula** – winter stew of pork and cabbage ²⁷ .
6. **Panettone** – sweet bread studded with candied fruit, a classic dessert ²⁷ .

Seek out traditional restaurants or trattorias (Trattoria Milanese, Antica Trattoria della Pesa) or modern options like Il Liberty.

Day 3 – Art & Spiritual Heritage

Morning

1. **Santa Maria delle Grazie & The Last Supper** – Visit Leonardo da Vinci's mural *Il Cenacolo* (The Last Supper) in the refectory of this Dominican convent. The museum is open Tuesday–Sunday 08:15–19:00 (last admission 18:45), closed Mondays and major holidays ²⁸ . Visits are limited to 15 minutes, and all tickets require advance reservations ²⁹ . Arrive 30 minutes before your time slot ³⁰ . Nearby, pop into the church's cloisters.
2. **Cimitero Monumentale** – This vast cemetery is a free open-air museum of sculpture and architecture. It contains elaborate mausoleums and the Famedio memorial honouring famous Milanese such as Alessandro Manzoni. Regular hours: Tuesday–Sunday 08:00–18:00; closed Mondays (except holidays); last entry 30 minutes before closing ³¹ . On major holidays the cemetery operates 08:00–13:00 ³² . Early morning or late afternoon is calmest ³³ .

Lunch

Visit **Mercato Centrale Milano**, adjacent to Milano Centrale station. This indoor market opens Sunday–Wednesday 06:30–23:00 and Thursday–Saturday 06:30–24:00 ³⁴ . It houses dozens of artisan food stalls offering fresh pasta, pizza, gelato, seafood and regional specialties. Grab a table, order from multiple vendors and enjoy informal dining.

Afternoon

1. **Museo Nazionale della Scienza e della Tecnologia Leonardo da Vinci** – This museum occupies a former Olivetan monastery and is one of Europe's largest science museums. Highlights include the Leonardo Galleries (170 historical models and artworks), the Toti submarine, lunar rock fragment and interactive labs ³⁵ . Opening hours: Tuesday–Friday 09:30–17:00; Saturday and Sunday 09:30–18:30; Monday closed ³⁶ . Standard tickets cost about €13 ³⁷ .
2. **Aperitivo & Dinner** – Return to the city centre or explore Isola district for modern bars and live music. Try contemporary aperitivo bars or return to Navigli for a relaxed dinner along the canal.

Day 4 – Day Trip to Lake Como (Optional)

If you'd like a change of pace, take a day trip to Lake Como. Trains from **Milano Centrale** to **Como S. Giovanni** take **about 40 minutes** and run roughly every hour ³⁸ ; a second-class ticket costs from €5.20 ³⁹ . The first train departs at 06:43 and the last returns around 21:43 ⁴⁰ . Once in Como:

1. **Como town** – Stroll around Piazza Duomo and the lakeside promenade, visit the Cathedral and the modernist Rationalist buildings.

2. **Funicular to Brunate** – Ride the historic funicular up to Brunate for panoramic views of the lake and Alps.
3. **Boat to Bellagio or Varenna** – Take a ferry to charming towns on the lake (approx. 1 hr). Enjoy gelato, explore gardens or swim.

Return to Milan in the evening. If you choose not to leave town, spend the day exploring additional museums like the **Museo Poldi Pezzoli**, **Museo del Novecento** or enjoy a spa day.

Day 5 – Markets, Parks & Modern Culture

Morning

1. **Nostalgic Markets and Shopping** – Start with coffee and *panzerotto* at Luini near the Duomo. Then explore local markets: the **Quadrilatero d'Oro** (fashion district), or check if there are open-air markets like **Mercato di Porta Romana** on the day you visit. Window-shop and pick up souvenirs.
2. **Museum or Church Visit** – If you haven't yet, visit **Museo del Novecento** for 20th-century Italian art or **Basilica di Sant'Ambrogio**, one of Milan's oldest churches.

Afternoon

1. **Indro Montanelli Gardens** – These historic gardens near Porta Venezia combine nature with culture, hosting the Civic Museum of Natural History and Planetarium ⁴¹. Enjoy a peaceful stroll among ponds and ancient trees.
2. **Guastalla Gardens or Parco Biblioteca degli Alberi** – For more tranquility, visit the intimate Guastalla Gardens with statues and a small pond ⁴², or explore the modern landscape design of the Biblioteca degli Alberi in Porta Nuova ⁴³. These parks offer quiet corners to read or picnic ⁴⁴.

Evening

1. **Farewell Dinner & Cultural Event** – End your trip with an elegant dinner. Consider dining at a **kyo-kaiseki** style restaurant (Japanese-Italian fusion) or revisit your favourite trattoria. If available, catch a concert at La Scala, a contemporary exhibition at **Hangar Bicocca**, or enjoy jazz at a local club.

Additional Tips

- **Timing and tickets** – Many attractions require advance reservations (Last Supper, Brera, Duomo terraces). Book online as soon as dates open.
- **Public transport** – Milan has an extensive metro/tram/bus network. Purchase a 48- or 72-hour travel card for convenience. Remember to validate tickets.
- **Language** – Italians appreciate attempts at Italian phrases; “Buongiorno” (good morning) and “Grazie” (thank you) go a long way.
- **Safety & etiquette** – Keep valuables secure in crowded areas. When visiting cemeteries or churches, dress modestly and speak quietly.

This itinerary balances Milan's rich culture, delicious cuisine and spaces for reflection. Adjust times and activities according to your interests and energy levels; the key is to savour the experience rather than rush.

1 2 3 4 **Milan Cathedral: history, interiors, curiosities - Italia.it**

<https://www.italia.it/en/lombardy/milan/milan-cathedral>

5 6 7 8 **Visit Vittorio Emanuele II gallery in Milan - Italia.it**

<https://www.italia.it/en/lombardy/milan/vittorio-emanuele-ii-gallery>

9 10 **The Best Trattorias in Milan for Old-School Dining—During the Winter Olympics, and Beyond | Vogue**

<https://www.vogue.com/article/best-trattorias-in-milan>

11 12 **Hours | Pinacoteca di Brera**

<https://pinacotecabrera.org/en/visit/orari/>

13 **Guided tour of the theater - Museo Teatrale alla Scala**

<https://www.museoscala.org/en/visit/museum-and-theater/guided-tour-of-the-theater.html>

14 15 **The History of Camparino in Galleria**

<https://www.camparino.com/history/>

16 17 **The World's Best Bar Is a 79-Year-Old Milan Legend**

<https://www.foodandwine.com/bar-basso-milan-top-global-bar-2026-11921327>

18 19 **Navigli Milan: The Guide - Tourist Italy**

<https://www.touristitaly.com/navigli-milan/>

20 21 **Home - Castello Sforzesco - Comune di Milano**

<http://www.milanocastello.it/it/>

22 41 42 43 44 **Discover Milan's most beautiful parks**

<https://www.domina.it/en/blog/i-parchi-piu-belli-di-milano-da-scoprire/>

23 24 **Plan your visit - Triennale Milano**

<https://triennale.org/en/visit/plan-your-visit>

25 26 **Vertical Forest | Milan | Stefano Boeri Architetti**

<https://www.stefanoboeriarchitetti.net/en/project/vertical-forest/>

27 **Typical Milanese Dishes | Air Dolomiti**

<https://www.airdolomiti.eu/destinations/milan-eu/what-to-eat/milanese-cuisine>

28 29 30 **Info - Museo del Cenacolo Vinciano | Sito Web Ufficiale**

<https://cenacolovinciano.org/en/info/>

31 32 33 **Monumental Cemetery Milan Opening Hours | Visitor Info**

<https://www.monumentalcemeterymilan.com/opening-hours/>

34 **Opening hours, how to get here and contacts | Mercato Centrale Milan**

<https://www.mercatocentrale.com/milan/info/>

35 36 37 **Museo Nazionale Scienza e Tecnologia Leonardo da Vinci - Abbonamento Musei**

https://abbonamentomusei.it/en/spazio_espositivo/museo-nazionale-scienza-e-tecnologia-leonardo-da-vinci/

38 39 40 **Tickets and timetables for Milano Centrale - Como S. Giovanni | Trenord**

<https://www.trenord.it/en/routes-and-timetables/most-searched-lines/milano-centrale-como-s-giovanni-route/>